Sherry (Xirui) Ren

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EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh **Dec. 2025**
B.S., Computer Science *Pittsburgh, PA*

- **GPA: 3.64/4.0** | *Magna Cum Laude* | Honors Student | NCWIT Aspirations in Computing (WI) Honorable Mention, 2022
- **Relevant Coursework:** Programming System Design for Mobile Robot Platforms, Intro to Artificial Intelligence, Algorithms & Data Structures I & II, Matrices & Linear Algebra, Computer Organization & Assembly, Systems Software, Software Engineering, Computer Graphics, Interface Design Methodology, 3D Media

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Pittsburgh, Department of Computer Science **Aug. 2023 – Dec. 2025**
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Led lab sections for an intermediate Java programming course, including optimization labs, for 250+ students.
- Debugged code with students one-on-one, reducing recurring errors on labs and assignments.
- Met weekly with the course instructor to review student work and plan upcoming labs.

Cyberspace Mall **Jun. 2025 – Dec. 2025**
Web Front-End Developer *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Designed and built a responsive website in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript for a healthcare clinic client, showcasing its services and improving the patient experience.
- Implemented intuitive navigation and UI features for consistent usability across devices and screen sizes.

PROJECTS

Kernel Error – Narrative-Driven Horror Game **2024 – 2025**
Developer | Unity, C# *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Built core gameplay combining 2D puzzles with 3D world interaction, including scene loading/unloading and state persistence.
- Engineered a JSON-based save/load system that preserves player progress across scenes.
- Designed a state-machine–driven branching system supporting multiple narrative endings.
- Authored custom glitch and VHS visual effects in Unity Shader Graph.

The Voyagers – Indie Puzzle Adventure Game **Oct. 2025**
Developer | 48-Hour Game Jam | Unity *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Implemented physics-driven mechanics for object rebound, trajectory control, and player feedback.
- Created in-game cutscenes and transition animations to support narrative flow.
- Iterated rapidly on gameplay and level design with a small team under a 48-hour deadline.

Pitt Challenge Hackathon **Oct. 2022**
Front-End Developer *Pittsburgh, PA*

- Co-designed, in a team of four, a health app that helps patients understand and track medical conditions.
- Built an interactive HTML/CSS prototype and added features to strengthen the final demo.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

- **Programming:** Python, C, C++, C#, Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS
- **Robotics & Engines:** ROS, Unity (Shader Graph), Unreal Engine
- **Frameworks & Tools:** React, Flutter, Git/GitHub, Blender, JSON, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office
- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (fluent)